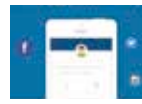




Visitor tracking

With ApartmentADDA's Gatekeeper App, you can track the visitors in your housing society, replacing the boring register at the security booth



Remove your offensive posts

If you aren't sure whether you have been offensive or swore a lot on social networks, then Clear on iOS is for you <http://digit.in/ClearAppiOS>

Best phones under 10k, 15k

Dear Agent 001, I want to buy two good phones, one below 15k and the other below 10k. My expectations are simple – I want good performance and long battery life from both these phones, including moderate camera quality. I am considering the



The Yu Yureka

Lenovo P70 but am open to other options, too, at the sub 15k range. For the sub 10k phone I expect good specs, performance (including camera performance) and moderate battery life, and for this I am considering the Yu Yureka, but am open to other suggestions, too. I am not much concerned about the brand. Both screens should be 5.5 inch or lesser. Thanks in advance.

–Parth Bhuta

A Hi Parth, It seems the Yu Yureka is the right choice for both your phones.

For the sub-10k phone, that would definitely be the best choice. If you want more options for the below 15k segment, take a look at the following:

Samsung Galaxy S3 Neo (good camera, respectable performance, good battery)
Nokia Lumia 640/640XL (respectable performance, good camera, good battery)
Honor 4X (decent performance, good camera and marathon battery)

Also, we expect one of the 2GB variants of the Asus Zenfone 2 (to be launched on April 23) to be in your budget.

That's a good performer, but you would compromise on camera and get moderate battery life in return.

GPU upgrade

I am planning to upgrade my graphics card. I am presently using an NVIDIA EN

210 graphic card which is not meeting my gaming needs. I plan to play games like Counter Strike Global Offensive, Left 4 Dead 2, F1 2014, Tomb Raider, Grand Theft Auto 5 etc. on my PC via steam.

I am currently using ASUS P5KPL-AM/PS motherboard with 3 GB RAM and Intel Core 2 Duo E7500 @ 2.93 Ghz processor. My budget is 15k rupees. Please suggest a good graphic card in my budget and I do not plan to change my motherboard. So please suggest a card which will be compatible with the above motherboard.

–Tanmay Agrawal

A Hey Tanmay, your motherboard has PCIe 1.1 and that isn't a problem because even the current generation of graphics cards are yet to fully utilise the bandwidth provided by 16 lanes on PCIe 1.1. There will be a minor difference in FPS since the encoding method used in older PCIe isn't as efficient as PCIe 2.0/3.0.

Your biggest problem, however, is that while most games will seem to run just fine on that CPU, the performance bottleneck is very severe and you can easily lose upto half your expected frame-rate to that bottleneck. At the same time, 3GB of DDRII RAM is also a severe limitation on



The GTX 960 might be the best mid-range card for everyone

your system and games like GTA V will chew through it in no time at all (we've had systems with 8GB RAM struggling to run that game).

You've also failed to mention the power of your SMPS or PSU as it's known. We would suggest that you first consider upgrading at least your RAM to a minimum of 6GB, and then using the rest of the cash to get yourself a GPU like the Nvidia 750Ti, which should set you back by about 10k. Ideally, we'd heartily recommend a complete system overhaul

so plan for that in the near future. Games like CS: GO and Left 4 Dead 2 should run comfortable on your system, however. So you're not that far out of the loop as far as your config is concerned.

Camera for serious amateur photographer

Hi Agent 001, thanks to using several iPhones over the years, I've finally been inspired enough to move to take a crack at photography beyond just smartphone cameras. As an aspiring amateur photographer interested in daily life, sports, and nature photography, what sort of camera would you suggest under 30-35k?

–Bajrang Sen

A Now this is a very tricky question. We'd recommend that you start out with a DSLR simply because a DSLR platform will give you the best combination of flexibility, upgradability and performance that you desire. The tricky part is choosing the right DSLR.

We'd suggest that you go for a Nikon D5100. It's an old camera, sure, but it's still a great camera and for the price it's retailing at, it's a steal. The performance of that camera is enough to give any mid-range DSLR a run for its money and it's powerful and flexible enough for just about every situation. To top it off, the camera is very quiet, even quieter than most Canon's at the same price, making it an ideal choice nature photography.

The camera should set you back by around ₹25,000, but the rest of your budget will need to be spent very carefully. You'll most probably receive an 18-55mm kit lens with the camera. Play around with it and try to understand the photos that you're taking. Learn your limitations and try to figure out how the lens is limiting you. Do you need more zoom or better macro performance? Will you need a tripod? What about a flash? How much zoom will you need? Are you taking portraits or pictures of birds on trees? All these questions only you can answer yourself. Take photos, analyze them. Understand your needs and upgrade accordingly. **d**